Indian trade.[1] British trade with India has certainly benefited, at the cost, according to Indian political and commercial opinion, of India's wider interests. The position is reversed in regard to the Dominions, especially Canada and Australia.[2] They struck a hard bargain with Britain and got most of the advantages at Britain's expense. In spite of this fact, continuous attempts are being made by them to get away from Ottawa and its entanglements in order to develop their own industries as well as their trade with other countries.[3] In Canada a leading political party, the Liberals, who are likely to be in power before long, are definitely committed to ending the Ottawa pact.[4] In

[1] "Referring to Indian trade, Sir William Currie said that the Ottawa agreements had been a definite advantage to Britain." Sir William was presiding over the meeting of the P. and O. Shipping Company in London on Dec. 5, 1934.

[2] The London *Economist* (June 1934) says that the Ottawa Conference "could only have been justified if it had increased the value of inter-imperial trade without diminishing the value of the Empire's trade with the rest of the world. In fact, it has merely increased very slightly the proportion that inter-imperial trade bears to the dwindling total of the Empire's trade. And this diversion has been much more in the interests of the Dominions than of Great Britain. Our imports from the Empire increased from £247,000,000 in 1931 to £249,000,000 in 1933, but our exports decreased from £170,600,000 to £163,500,000. And the fact remains that between 1929 and 1933 our exports to the Empire declined by 50.9 per cent., while our imports from the Empire declined only 32.9 per cent. The decline in our exports to foreign countries was not quite so great, but the decline in our imports from these countries was much greater."

[3] The Melbourne *Age* does not like the Ottawa Agreement. In its view Ottawa is "acting as a constant irritant and is being increasingly recognised as an egregious blunder." (Quoted in *Manchester Guardian Weekly*, October 19, 1934.)

[4] Even Mr. Bennett, the present Conservative Prime Minister of Canada, has been a thorn in the side of the British Government in trade matters. He is talking now in terms of 'New Deals' and records a surprising conversion. Owing to the dangerous influence of Mr. Litvinov, Sir Stafford Cripps and Mr. John Strachey, he has turned collectivist. This should be a sign and a warning to all Conservatives, Liberals, I.C.S. men, etc., to avoid thinking or associating with those who do so, or else they might themselves become converts to dangerous doctrines. (Since writing the above, the Liberal Party in Canada, under the leadership of Mr. King, has swept the polls and come into power.)